

The Client Acquisition OS

How the whole thing fits together

Read this once. Then work from the tracker and come back to the individual guides when you need them.

The problem this solves

You can get a list of every business in your city this afternoon. It won't help.

A list tells you who exists. It doesn't tell you which buildings are worth your time, who signs the cleaning contract, or whether there's any reason for them to take your call this month. So you email a thousand offices, they all already have a cleaner, and nothing happens.

A list is not a pipeline.

A pipeline is a list plus three things: a reason each account is worth pursuing, a named person who can say yes, and a reason to make contact now rather than someday.

Add those and the same thousand names become forty worth working — which you can actually work properly, because forty is a number one person can handle.

Why most commercial outreach fails

Most commercial buildings already have a cleaner. They are not unhappy enough to go looking, and they're not switching because your email was better written.

They switch when something changes:

- They move into a new building
- They open a second location
- A new management company takes over
- They hire someone whose job includes vendors
- They finish a renovation

Those moments are visible in public records — permits, business listings, job postings, property portfolios. Nobody hides them. Almost nobody in this industry looks for them.

That's the opening. Not better copy. Better timing.

The order

ACCOUNT → PERSON → TRIGGER → OUTREACH → CONVERSATION
→ WALKTHROUGH → PROPOSAL → WIN or LOSS → LEARN

Each step narrows the one before it. Run them out of order and you'll write a personalised email to the wrong person at a building you can't service about a reason you invented.

ACCOUNT — which buildings

Define what you can actually service first: radius, building types, size floor, things you don't do. Then build a list from public sources and cut it hard. Expect to keep about one in four. → **04 Prospecting Guide, 05 ICP and Personas**

PERSON — who signs

In a dental office the practice manager signs, not the dentist. In a 30-person office it's the office manager, not the managing partner. Getting this wrong wastes the account. → **05 ICP and Personas**

TRIGGER — why now

The dated, public reason this account is worth contacting this quarter. Eleven of them, with where to find each. → **03 Trigger Library**

OUTREACH — the contact

Say what you observed. Say what you do. Make a conditional offer. Ask an easy question. Three emails, then stop. → **06 Outreach Sequences**

CONVERSATION — the reply

Answer the same day. Don't quote a price over email. → **07 Reply Handling**

WALKTHROUGH — the site visit

Where the contract is won. Measure properly, watch for the five things that destroy margin, and become the person they want to hire. → **08 Walkthrough Guide**

PROPOSAL — the document

Their words back to them, a specific scope, three options, and what happens if something goes wrong. → **09 Proposal Guide**

WIN or LOSS → LEARN

Ask why on every loss and record it as a category. One loss is noise. Ten coded losses tell you whether the problem is your price, your timing, or your targeting.

Scoring

Every account gets five scores, out of 20 total. The tracker does the arithmetic.

	Points	The question
Fit	0–5	Is this the kind of building I should pursue?
Value	0–5	Is it worth the effort if I win it?
Trigger	0–5	Is there a dated, public reason to contact them now?
Access	0–3	Can I reach someone who actually decides?
Service	0–2	Could I genuinely service it?

16–20 work now · **12–15** work in order · **8–11** research or wait · **below 8** stop.

The score isn't a prediction. It's a way of deciding what to do on Monday morning. Two accounts scoring 17 and 9 aren't 17/9ths as likely to buy — the 17 is just the better use of your next hour.

The rule the whole system depends on

A trigger is an event, not a conclusion.

You saw a permit. You did not see their cleaning contract.

So you may say *"I noticed you moved to Commerce Street."* You may not say *"you probably need a new cleaner."*

This matters for three reasons, in ascending order of importance:

It's checkable, so it survives someone asking how you found them. It keeps you out of trouble with email rules that take a dim view of misleading messages. And **buyers can tell**. Everyone guessing at them sounds the same. Someone who states a fact and makes a conditional offer sounds like a person who did the work.

What good looks like in month one

- A scored list of twenty to forty accounts you'd genuinely be glad to win
- A weekly habit of checking for triggers
- Ten to thirty first-touch emails sent, in small batches
- Several conversations
- At least one walkthrough

Not: a signed contract in week one. Commercial cleaning decisions take longer than that, and anything promising otherwise is guessing.

What this doesn't do

It doesn't make the calls. It doesn't run the walkthrough. It won't tell you a prospect is unhappy with their current cleaner — nothing can, from the outside.

It removes the guesswork about who to contact and when. The work is still the work.

If you do one thing

Every account you're actively working has a next action and a date.

Not a status. Not a note. A specific thing you will do, and the day you'll do it.

Everything else here — the scoring, the triggers, the sequences, the tracker — exists to support that single habit. Operators who have it win contracts with far worse systems than this one. Operators who don't have it lose accounts they'd already won the hard part of.